The most commonly used one is the GNU General Public License (GPL). If a code is included to a project that is under GPL license, then the final modified version must be released under GPL. The GPL code cannot be mixed with any other proprietary source code. Other examples of this category are GNU Lesser General Public License (LGPL) and Mozilla Public License 2.0 (MPL 2.0).

So, it is the license that separates the general open source community from the free software community.

Why contribute to open source?

Open source software plays an essential part in the functioning of daily-use devices, such as PCs, smartphones, and even cars. Thanks to open source software global tech has evolved at a rapid pace since 2000. Without this transformation, the startup ecosystem would not have thrived.

A key benefit of taking the help of open source while starting a new project is that it saves time and energy spent reinventing everything from scratch. You can simply reuse some of the previous work released under an open source license. By building upon it, you can create something new and innovative. With open source, you can focus on what's important for your work instead of every time going through the basics.

Another benefit that open source brings is that it can open many new opportunities and careers by helping you become a part of several open-

Bounties

Websites like Bountysource and IssueHunt offer 'bounties' or compensations for fixing certain problems of various open source projects. This means you can make money by assigning yourself to specific issues and contributing to them. There are other websites as well where you can search for issues that offer a bounty.

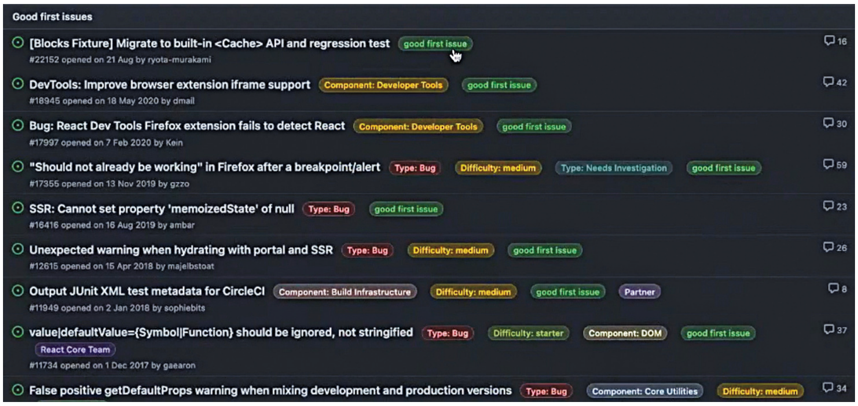

Fig. 2: Screenshot of the GitHub page showing different good first issues (Credit: OSI 2021)

Fig. 3: Screenshot showing a user who has already taken up an issue (Credit: OSI 2021)

knowledge communities out there. Open source is one of the most efficient ways to learn and hone your technical skills and knowledge because you get to work on highly-technical projects.

You may have heard of open data for sharing datasets for machine learning model training and to access any previous research work. This 'open community' approach helps support various sectors such as education, business, creatives, and many more to achieve their objectives. Imagine reviewing and sharing codes for such purposes while also learning to collaborate with very smart people around the globe. Sounds fun?

Speaking of community interaction, by collaborating with other project developers, you come across different people and ideas. And that helps you build your network.

Far from the stereotype

Whenever someone is told to describe a developer, most people think of a person working alone with machines. But the truth is the opposite when it comes to real-life work. A big part of software development is communication. Yes, you have to write code for machines. But more importantly, you need to work with your peers and other developers.

Communication also entails getting information and feedback from end-users, UX team, product designers, and everyone else directly involved in a project. Basically, a